

How to Choose the Right CIAM for Your Integration Architecture

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In the last three articles in this series on CIAM, I have covered various open source and commercial frameworks, and explained the architecture as well as the pros and cons of these frameworks. This last article in the series will help enterprise architects to prepare a digital migration architecture to choose the right CIAM solution suitable for the target architecture.

This article will cover some important CIAM frameworks. Let's begin.

Microsoft Active Directory (AD) B2C

When you are integrating a CIAM solution for your enterprise architecture, and you wish to prepare a solution that has serverless architecture without depending on users for resource handling and deployment based model change, then Microsoft AD B2C is the right choice.

Microsoft's Active Directory (AD) is a B2C based CIAM solution, which is based on serverless architecture (e.g., Azure Logic functions or AWS Lambda). It can be designed to integrate with the on-premises Active Directory through online/offline synchronisation using AD Connect. It is a multi-tenant solution that has integrated architecture suitable for both SaaS and PaaS based architecture adoption.

Pros:

- Serverless architecture
- Synchronises with on-premise AD

data store (AD Connect)

- Integrated cloud solution and flexible for hybrid cloud integration/adoption
- Flexibility in cloud adoption and SDK support for cloud migration
- Multi-tenant solution for cloud native architecture

Cons:

- High licence and support cost

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If you are preparing a CIAM solution that has centralised data governance with a preference based user dashboard and real-time report on access metrics, then choose UnboundID as the framework to integrate your architecture.

UnboundID is a unique CIAM solution. It has a centralised data store integrated with LDAP SDK and proxy management architecture. It provides a preference management facility in a dashboard, federated single sign-on and high performance LDAP directory synchronisation. PingIdentity bought UnboundID in 2016 with the mission to provide a large scale CIAM solution for cloud and mobile based integration with a unified architecture.

Pros:

- Preference management facility in dashboard
- Centralised data governance
- Real-time report of metrics (usage statistics)
- Data transmission across instances
- Security of data management
- Multi-tenant solution combined with LDAP integration
- Unified architecture combining the facilities of PingIdentity
- API integration for real-time metrics
- Support for centralised data governance using the Identity data store and data sync services

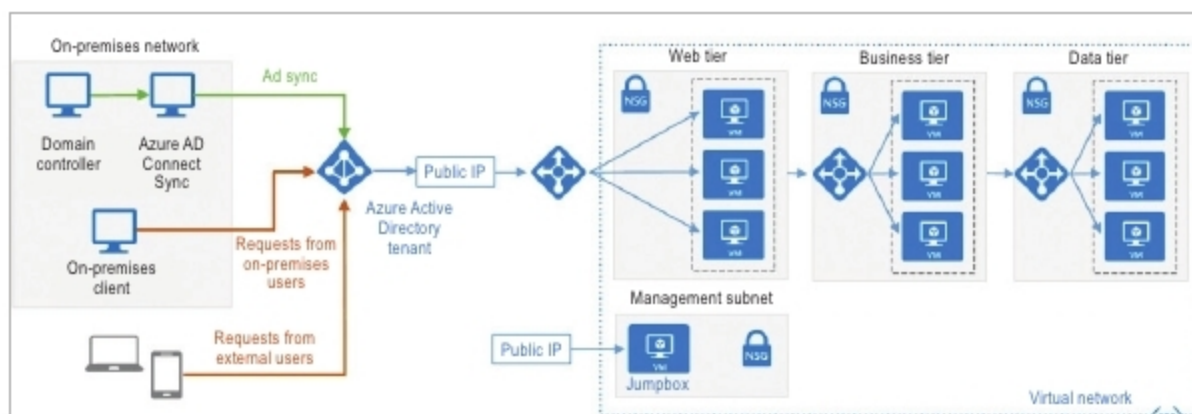


Figure 1: Sample architecture of implementing CIAM using Microsoft AD B2C